

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

- Intellectual Property refers to creations of the mind.
- It is any idea, invention, creative work, or design that someone produces with their mind and can be recognized as their own creation.
- This includes:
 - Logos
 - brand names
 - Websites
 - Software
 - online contents
 - Products
 - Algorithms
 - Design
 - Codes etc.

Intellectual Property Rights (IPRs)

- ▶ These are the legal rights that protect creations of the mind, such as inventions, software, digital content, brand names, logos, designs, and creative works.
- ▶ These rights give creators or owners, the exclusive control over how their digital or creative work is used, copied, shared, sold, modified, distributed and monetized.
- ▶ Categories of IPRs are:
 - ▶ Copyright
 - ▶ Trademark
 - ▶ Patent
 - ▶ Trade Secrets

COPYRIGHT

- ▶ This is the legal protection given to the digital content a cyberpreneur creates, such as website text, software code, online courses, graphics, videos, and marketing materials. It ensures that only the creator can copy, publish, distribute, or modify that exact digital work.
- ▶ Copyrights are registered at the Nigerian Copyright Commission (NCC)..
- ▶ Copyright lasts for as long as the creator is alive, and then it continues for 70 more years after the creator dies.

TRADEMARK

- ▶ This protects business identity such as brand name, logo, slogan.
- ▶ It protects signs, symbols, name, phrase that a business uses to identify its products or services and distinguish them from others in the market.
- ▶ Trademarks are registered at the Trademarks, Patents and Designs Registry.
- ▶ A trademark lasts for 7 years after it is first registered. After that, the owner can renew it every 14 years as many times as they want.

PATENT

- ▶ This is a legal protection granted for a new invention or innovative solution that a cyberpreneur creates.
- ▶ It gives the inventor exclusive rights to make, use, sell, or license the invention for a certain period, preventing others from copying or profiting from it without permission.
- ▶ Patents are registered at the Trademarks, Patents and Designs Registry
- ▶ For an invention to be patentable, it must meet three main conditions:
 - ▶ Novelty (Newness): The invention must be something new
 - ▶ Inventive Step: The invention must involve a creative or innovative idea.
 - ▶ Industrial Applicability (Usefulness): It must be practical and usable in some industry or business.
- ▶ A patent typically lasts for 20years.

TRADE SECRETS

- ▶ These are confidential business information that give a cyberpreneur a competitive advantage.
- ▶ Although they are not registered with the government, they are protected by keeping them secret.
- ▶ Unlike patents or copyrights, trade secrets are not publicly disclosed; their value comes from being kept secret.
- ▶ Trade secret may include algorithms, codes, service formulas, processes etc.
- ▶ A trade secret lasts as long as you can keep it secret.